

# Around the world in 1 Click

Are travel portals good for more than just reading up on destinations? Let's find out

Going on a trip involves more than just packing your bags and hopping onto a plane or a train. Whether it's a couple of days in Khandala or a foreign jaunt, planning for your trip can be trying, especially if you're not a seasoned traveller. Information isn't always easy to come by—you have to make calls to travel agents, hotels and airlines to fix the itinerary and procure the tickets.

Travel Web sites and sites of airlines and travel agents help a modern day traveller by providing select information about destinations. But at the same time, they can also overwhelm—and sometimes confuse—travellers with unnecessary, irrelevant data. You can reserve airline seats, choose a hotel in any city, book a tour package online as well as get a cab to the airport. But can you find a good deal online?

## Research

The key to travelling smart involves

research about the destination. Turn to the Web for help and all the groundwork for your trip can be easily configured. For example, the tour itinerary, weather conditions, special places of interest, amount of money needed—you can find out all of this on the Web. And that too in just a couple of hours.

If, for instance, you can't decide whether to go trekking through the Amazon rain forest or spend a romantic getaway at the Pyramids, visit [www.lonelyplanet.com](http://www.lonelyplanet.com), which is an excellent place to start. Though its World Guide is not as comprehensive as other guides, Lonely Planet has some really unique information on a lot of worldwide destinations. Browsing through maps of continents and cities will help you zero in on a destination that catches your fancy. Apart from some fairly exciting slideshows and first-hand accounts from travellers, this site features well-written reviews about different countries which focus on problems such as political insurgencies,

IMAGING: Ram